

# KF48 Meeting Version of Teachings

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Karis is an invitation to a relationship based on mutual generosity.

“Search me, O God, and know my heart. Examine me and know my thoughts. See if there is any way in me that causes pain, and lead me in the ways of eternity.” (Psalm 139:23–24)

**0:01    OPENING**

**0:02    PRESENTING**

**0:06    KARIS CIRCULATION**

**0:07    GUIDELINES & LIMITATIONS**

**0:08    MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION TRAINING**

We have the opportunity to rebuild our foundations with KF Confession 11:

We take responsibility for any damage that we have done.

Training to be still and silent in body and mind lays the foundation that we need for growing into our potential. We can apply this skill when we feel frustrated, compelled, or anxious, and when we or others make mistakes. In KF we are learning to spend more time observing and less time talking. This is one of the reasons that we adhere to time restraints in our sharing. When we share moderately and efficiently, we exercise restraint and show respect for our listeners.

Meditation helps us learn to dwell without words. In his vision, the Apostle John witnessed a worship ceremony in heaven that included thirty minutes of silence.<sup>1</sup> Silence during worship today would drive most Christians crazy! As we learn to be silent, we no longer use words to suppress our anxiety or to keep God at a comfortable distance. Silent minds let go of words, images, or sensations and come to the place of pure connection with God. This might be the connection that Paul talks about in First Corinthians: “Now we see through a mirror of riddles, but then we will see face to face.”<sup>2</sup> When our minds learn to dwell without words, we come face to face with God.

In this lesson, we will revisit **Centering Prayer**<sup>3</sup> while practicing the **Sunlight Meditation**. Take the meditation posture. Lift the top of your head so that your neck is somewhat straightened. Lower your chin a little and let your shoulders fall back. Gently close your eyes and keep them closed throughout this meditation. Allow your body to regulate your breathing as you begin one minute of **Alternate Nostril Breathing**. *(Pause for 1 minute)*

Now, let go of **Alternate Nostril Breathing** and move to **Centering Prayer**. Allow a centering word, which may be a phrase, a word, or an image, to float to the surface of your mind. *(Pause for 5 seconds)* As you breathe, bring your word to mind, then let it go and rest in the stillness. If your mind wanders, use the word and your breath to re-collect yourself. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Now, gently lift your eyes toward the middle of your forehead and feel a slight stretch in your eye muscles. You might find it helpful to imagine that you are looking at the inside of your forehead. Breathe. If you need to recall your mind, use your word. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

Imagine that the sun or a lamp is shining into your eyes. *(Pause)* Imagine what the light and heat would feel like on your forehead. Breathe. Practice dwelling silently in the light for two minutes. Use your word to recall your mind. *(Pause for 2 minutes, announcing when one minute has passed)*

Pause. Take a deep breath and stretch. Gently open your eyes and re-engage with the meeting.

Our hymn of gratitude and mercy is *Great is Thy Faithfulness*.

Pardon for sin and a peace that endureth,  
Thine own dear presence to cheer and to guide;  
Strength for today and bright hope for tomorrow,  
Blessings all mine, with ten thousand beside!<sup>4</sup>

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about this training?”)*

## **0:20 KARIS CONFESSION**

## **0:21 TOOLBOX**

KF Confession 11 helps us learn new habits:

We take responsibility for any damage that we have done.

Last week we explored SET—S-E-T—which stands for Support, Empathy, and Truth. These three steps will help you communicate more effectively with others.<sup>5</sup> Each Idol type struggles with at least one area of SET. Mastery types resist supporting others. Resigned types suppress any effort toward empathy. Self-effacing types wish to avoid telling the truth.

In your early KF training, you learned how to take responsibility for the damage you have done to yourself. This damage can be physical, mental, emotional, or spiritual and is often the result of self-hate. In addition, you carry inherited debt, or damage, from others, and what you do with that debt is also your responsibility. Now that you have begun your journey of discovery and have some tools to facilitate your own healing, you can take responsibility for dealing with the damage done to you by others. Whatever that damage might be, you can thrive within your design and your present limitations. You can learn from the woman with the hemorrhage, and you can also take Dr. Horney’s advice, which is to get all the help you can. Get all the help you can as you continue to train for your opportunity to touch Jesus.

Hopefully, by now, you have come to understand that all misorientation causes damage. In misorientation you step out of harmony with God and the Creation, and by willfully using your unique power and authority to serve the Idol, you injure God’s design and obstruct His purposes. You know this, and that is why you are working hard to free yourself from misorientation. As you become more oriented, you will begin to see how your marvelous power can be used to help orient your community. Even when you have not actively participated in damaging the community, you can be an agent of healing and change. You can

learn to take active responsibility for guiding others toward orientation by being careful and mindful about how you live your life. The positive results in your community will encourage you to keep pursuing the path of your own orientation. Who knows what might be possible? This vision of hope and influence widens your horizon as you boldly explore territory that you, and perhaps others, have never seen before.

Our example is Jesus, the progenitor of our faith. He never did any damage to anyone and yet He continually worked to restore damage. He paid for debts that were not His own. Although He was not actively trying to restore everyone and everything all the time, the quality of His life gave everyone He met the opportunity to restore and be restored. We are His ambassadors, and He calls each of us to participate in the same adventure.<sup>6</sup>

Nancy used to think that she was called to restore everyone and everything all of the time. It was a terrific burden, and she used that story as an excuse to avoid her own development. She did not understand that her own restoration and development was her first priority. You cannot restore the Creation without first restoring yourself. Restoring yourself will take time and resources, and depending on how much damage has been done, you may find that in the first months, or even years, of KF training you will need to invest most of your resources in your own healing.

God wants everyone to have an abundant life, and by living a real life, you can co-labor with Him to make His desire a reality in this material world.<sup>7</sup> Real lives reveal God's goodness in all the ups and downs of life—when the tide comes in and when the tide goes out. As you live your life fully engaged with reality, you can work with God to help others live abundantly. Helping others is not meant to be a one-way street; when you help the community to live abundantly, abundance circulates back to you. There are as many ways to influence a community and circulate gifts as there are people. You might clean houses, manage employees, or work as a volunteer. You might be designed to lead a large community, perhaps as a politician or a pastor. If you are a parent, you have the potential to exert far-reaching influence by teaching your children to circulate within the family. Circulating children become circulating adults who are complete, mature, and fully equipped to change the world.

If you are tearing down or stealing from others, you are participating in damage and harming yourself. If, however, you are contributing to the MATH—the money, abilities, time, and health—of your community, you are helping your community to live abundantly, and by helping your community to live abundantly, you are helping yourself. You might be working in a job that is dishonest, poisonous, or greed-driven and drains the resources of the community, but you can fight the good fight to change that culture. You become an agent of positive change not through judgment and hostility but by working hard to live a holy life and cheerfully refusing to participate in evil. Now that you have worked hard on your orientation, you will want to protect it. So, cheerfully refuse to participate in evil.<sup>8</sup>

Our prayer might go something like this:

*Captain of the hosts, I want to be ready for the mission of abundance. (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Toolbox?")*

**0:30    SHARING**

**1:00    BIBLE TEACHING**

In Romans chapter 12, Paul teaches us how to restore and support the Christian community. He gives us further guidance in chapter 13, so you might like to read both chapters together. Taking responsibility for damage that we have done is a great gift to those we have damaged and, also, to ourselves—and when we co-labor with God to restore damage that we did not actively cause, we give an even greater gift. This greater gift flows out of the growing wealth of Christ within us. In Karis Fellowships, we are participating in each other's healing and restoration, and through that effort we are helping God heal the world.

This is Nancy's translation of the last verse of chapter 12.

*Do not allow yourselves to be conquered by injury; rather, conquer injury by living in active good.<sup>9</sup> (Repeat)*

Now let's put this verse in its context and see what Paul means when he tells us to conquer the power of injury with active good. Here is Nancy's translation of **Romans 12:17–21**.

<sup>17</sup>Never render harm in return for harm. Consider in advance what would be a virtuous response in the eyes of all people. <sup>18</sup>If it is possible, be peaceable with everyone through accessing the resources of your own inner peace. <sup>19</sup>You who are blessed with God's love, do not punish anyone, but leave a place for God's wrath, for it is written: "Punishment is Mine", says the Lord. "I, Myself, will pay it back."<sup>10</sup> <sup>20</sup>Instead, "when someone who hates you is hungry, supply them with bits of something to eat; if thirsty, furnish them with drink. For when you do this, you heap burning coals upon their head."<sup>11</sup> <sup>21</sup>Do not allow yourselves to be conquered by injury; rather, conquer injury by choosing active good.

Take a deep breath.

"Conquer injury by choosing active good." This sentence summarizes what Paul is saying in our passage.

Let's look at four points that we can learn from his teaching.

### 1. Violated legal systems

We can see in this passage, and also at the end of Romans 13, that our constant temptation is to react in a misoriented way to whatever we perceive as injury or harm. When events or people violate our claims and hurt our pride, our perceptions become distorted, and we judge that violation and hurt as personal injury.

### 2. Circulate goodness

As the people of God, even when we are damaged by another person's choices and actions, we do not retaliate by returning evil for evil or harm for harm. Paying back is simply a means of defending our pride system. Paul is not telling us to be doormats, however; he is encouraging us to circulate active goodness for our own sake.

### 3. Consider in advance

KF training prepares us to respond to every situation in an oriented way and helps us put into practice Paul's injunction to consider in advance what would be a virtuous response. Let's get real. Injury from others is a fact of life. How will you choose to handle it? If you are living in active orientation, you will be able to recognize and then transcend the violations of your legal system and the injuries to your

pride. The resources that you have been wasting in pride protection can then be redirected toward the creative management of real assault from others.

#### 4. Protect yourself

Sometimes another person's self-hate is so extreme that you will need to protect yourself from that person. Proverbs 22:3 and 27:12 teach us to foresee injury and take steps to protect ourselves. Most people are addicted to anxious fears, rage, chaos, and drama, all of which cause injury, and the media encourages and exploits that addiction. Wise people, however, have learned through experience how to seek peace and protect themselves in an oriented way. They are able to consider in advance what might be a virtuous response in difficult situations.<sup>12</sup> Seek counsel and support. Learn to prepare yourself with orientation and protect yourself with goodness before you find yourself conquered by injury.

Some years ago, Nancy realized that she could not maintain a peaceful life if she continued in a certain friendship. For nearly a year, her friend had been mindlessly blaming others for the chaotic outcomes that she herself created. When the friend finally dropped the relationship, Nancy was able to let her go, but she regretted that she had not confronted the problems in the friendship sooner. Her self-effacing neurosis had imposed taboos that blocked her ability to be honest and care for herself. She compulsively showed her friend empathy and support but could not choose the active good of sticking to her own business, courageously defending her own boundaries, and moderately sharing her own reality. This active good might have helped her friend avoid further injury to herself and others. Instead, the friend was conquered by both imagined and real injuries and became the arsonist of her own wildfires. Nancy spent months chasing her around with a bucket of water while she ran around with a torch. Nancy's misorientation in the service of her Idol undermined her ability to foresee the evil and protect herself.

When the Idol feels injured, its first response is to retaliate out of self-hate. Allowing yourself to be mastered by self-hate will start fires, but you are learning to consider in advance how to protect yourself and respond to every injury, whether real or imagined, with orientation. Do not allow injury to conquer and enslave you, forcing you to retaliate, manipulate, or retreat. Rather, conquer the injury by choosing active good.

Our prayer might go something like this:

*Prince of Peace, help me conquer injury with active good. (Repeat)*

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, "Does anyone have comments or questions about the Bible teaching?")*

#### 1:10 INTEGRATION

Sip some purified water, and prepare to take some notes. Assume a meditation posture, and breathe.  
*(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Here is our integration focus: *Consider an uncomfortable situation in your community. (Repeat) (Pause for 30 seconds)*

#### The FAITH Process

## Feelings

As you *consider an uncomfortable situation in your community*, how does it feel? *(Pause)* Your feelings are yours to teach you about yourself, to guide you, and to train you. They can often be uncomfortable. *(Pause)* Recognize with compassion whatever you are experiencing, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

## Awareness without judgment

Allow your experience to rest in your awareness. You might notice a compulsion to push thoughts or feelings away, to judge them, or to justify them. Accept with compassion that your pride might be hurt. Just observe your experience as you *consider this uncomfortable situation*. *(Pause)* Feelings and passing thoughts are not right or wrong; they just are. Give yourself permission now to explore them without judgment, and breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

## Inquiry: What is my body saying?

Bring your attention to your body and notice what it is doing when you *consider this uncomfortable situation in your community*. What sensations are there? *(Pause)* Your body is always talking to you. You may not understand its language right now, but you can observe. For example, you might recognize what obsession, frustration, or passive aggression feels like in your body. Breathe. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

## Talk to Jesus

You might imagine that you are leaning back in the safe and loving arms of Jesus as together you *consider this uncomfortable situation in your community*. Do you judge the situation as good or evil? *(Pause)* What do you believe? What story do you want to tell? *(Pause)* Are you afraid of something—perhaps of hurt pride or self-hate? Observe your responses as just information, and breathe with a long exhaling breath. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

## Heal

As you breathe, repeat the word *Welcome*. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

*(Pause for 8 seconds or one long breath after each statement)*

- Welcome this opportunity to explore how you can be more trustworthy in your community.
- Welcome the gentle Holy Spirit of truth, who works toward peace.
- Welcome your present reality and the progress you have made.
- Welcome what your community is teaching you about yourself. *(Pause for 10 seconds)*

Now, as you breathe, you might use the following statements as a confession to the Lord and turn away from the Idol Self. On the exhale, let go.<sup>13</sup>

*(Pause for 5 seconds after each statement)*

- As I help heal my community, I let go of the longing for power and control.
- As I help heal my community, I let go of the longing for care and admiration.
- As I help heal my community, I let go of the longing for safety and survival.
- As I help heal my community, I let go of the longing for perfection. *(Pause for 30 seconds)*

*(Optional)* Continue to breathe while I test for further integration.

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about the integration?”)*

## 1:28 ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

Thank you for drawing us together for healing and training. Hold us in the power of this new direction as You guide us toward our real glory and authority. Set us free with the truth about our lives as You lead us to the next step in our healing. Help us co-labor with You to reorient our lives for a more effective flow and to become more trustworthy for our own sake, for the sake of the community, and for Your sake so that the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus may be seen in this world. Amen.

Take a deep breath.

*(If time permits, ask, “Does anyone have comments or questions about this meeting?”)*

## 1:29 ANNOUNCEMENTS

The next Karis Fellowships training cycle begins in March. KF Admin requests that all current members register now on the website for the next KF cycle to make the registration tasks easier.

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<sup>1</sup> Rev. 8:1.

<sup>2</sup> 1 Cor.13:12.

<sup>3</sup> [www.centeringprayer.com](http://www.centeringprayer.com).

<sup>4</sup> *Great is Thy Faithfulness* by Thomas Chisholm (1866–1960), [www.youtube.com/watch?v=dTKlqmdfHSk](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dTKlqmdfHSk).

<sup>5</sup> [www.chrisakins.com/communicating-effectively-in-difficult-situations/](http://www.chrisakins.com/communicating-effectively-in-difficult-situations/).

<sup>6</sup> 2 Cor. 5:20.

<sup>7</sup> Matt. 6:10.

<sup>8</sup> Rom. 12:21.

<sup>9</sup> Rom. 12:21 in Nancy’s translation.

<sup>10</sup> Deut. 32:35.

<sup>11</sup> Prov. 25:21–22.

<sup>12</sup> Rom. 12:17.

<sup>13</sup> [www.camillecaldwell.com/WelcomePrayer.html](http://www.camillecaldwell.com/WelcomePrayer.html). Adapted for Karis Fellowships by Nancy Diven.